



GAME RULES

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PART 2: CORE CONCEPTS

OGÓLNE



2.1 MODELS



Every Archon Studio miniature in a player's army is a model - a single entity ([Marine](#), [Zergling](#), Ultralisk) mounted on its own independent base. All rules apply to the model through its base. The physical miniature above the base is purely for aesthetic purposes.

2.2 UNITS



An army is made up of [Units](#). A Unit is one or more [models](#) acting together as a single formation.

- **Composition:** Each **Unit Card** specifies the number of [models](#) it contains. An infantry squad may have many soldiers; a vehicle may operate alone.
- **Cohesion:** [Models within](#) a Unit fight and [move](#) as a single entity. They are bound by the rules of **Coherency** (Part [4.4](#)), representing the discipline and communication required to operate on a battlefield.
- **Friendly & Enemy:** A player's own [Units](#) are [Friendly](#). The opponent's [Units](#) are **Enemies**.

2.3 BASES



Every model stands on a base, and that base is the single most important physical object in the game. It does not matter how a miniature is posed, whether a [Zealot](#) is mid-leap or a [Hydralisk](#) is rearing back to strike; the rules see only the base. Every measurement, every [Line of Sight](#) check, and every question about whether two [models](#) are touching or overlapping is resolved

by looking at their bases, nothing else.

Every model must be mounted on the correct base size as specified on the **Unit Card**. Using the wrong base size changes a model's physical footprint and directly affects gameplay, so consistency matters.

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- **No Overlap:** Bases may never overlap. If a model cannot be set without its base overlapping another base or impassable terrain, it simply cannot go there.
- **Scenic Freedom:** Players are free to add scenic basing, custom conversions, player dramatic poses, and flight stands. The game encourages creativity - just know that, for rules purposes, the base and the **Size** Characteristic on the **Unit Card** are the only things that count. A Marine standing on a pile of rubble is no taller than one standing on a bare base. A Mutalisk on a towering flight stand has the same **Size** as one on a short peg.
- **Flight Stands:** If a model uses a flight stand, the bottom of the stand counts as the model's base for all measurements and positioning.
- **Wobbly Model Syndrome:** When a model cannot sit flat on the terrain, both players should agree on where the model would stand if the surface allowed it. Set the model as close to that spot as possible, or use a marker to indicate its actual position. The model is treated as occupying the agreed position for all purposes.

2.4 TAGS

Tags are keywords printed at the bottom of each **Unit Card**. They allow rules to target specific types of Units without repeating lengthy definitions.

2.4.1 Faction Tags

Faction Tags identify a Unit's allegiance.

- **Race Tags:** Terran, Zerg, Protoss.
- **Sub-Faction Tags:** Specific broods or organisations, e.g., Kerrigan's Swarm, Raynor's Raiders.
- **Function:** During Army Building, a player may include only Units and Tactical Cards that share Faction Tags with the chosen **Faction Card**.

2.4.2 Combat Tags

Combat Tags identify a Unit's physical nature and tactical class.

Type Tags: Armoured, Biological, Light, Mechanical, Psionic, Flying, Ground.

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- **Targeting:** Some weapons can fire only at specific **tags** (e.g., "Target: Flying").
- **Surge:** A weapon's Surge efficiency triggers only when the target has the **Combat Tag** listed in the weapon's **Surge Type** (Part 8.7.4).
- **Bonuses:** Abilities such as **ANTI-EVADE** (X) or **PIERCE** (X) often apply only against specific **tags**.

Note: The **Ground Combat Tag** and the **GROUND LEVEL** elevation (Part 8.5.3) are distinct concepts. A **Flying** Unit standing on the playmat is at **GROUND LEVEL** but does not have the **Ground Combat Tag**. Throughout these rules, **Ground** in bold caps always refers to the **Combat Tag**. **GROUND LEVEL** always refers to elevation.

2.5 PLAYER ROLES

At any given moment, each player occupies one or more of the following roles. These terms appear throughout the rules and determine who makes decisions, who rolls **dice**, and who is affected by an ability.

- **Active Player:** The player whose turn it is to act. Some rules, particularly **Reactions**, refer to this to determine priority when both sides respond to the same event.
- **Controlling Player:** The player who commands a specific Unit, model, or Token. They make all decisions and roll all **dice**. Certain abilities (e.g., Neural Parasite) can transfer control; the new controller then acts in every respect as though the Unit were their own.
- **Friendly and Enemy:** Anything belonging to the **controlling player** or their teammates is **Friendly**. Anything belonging to an opponent is an **enemy**. In **team games**, all teammates are **Friendly** to one another.

2.6 KEYWORDS AND RULE PRIORITY

2.6.1 Keywords



Keywords are written in **BOLD CAPS** (e.g. SIDEARM, PIERCE, HIDDEN). always means the same thing, regardless of the Unit in which it appears. Full definitions are in Part 11: Keyword Glossary and Definitions.

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Keywords do not stack. Gaining the same keyword twice provides no extra benefit. If a keyword has a numeric value (e.g., PRECISION (1) and PRECISION (2)), use only the highest value.

2.6.2 The Priority



Specific Rules take precedence over General Rules. If text on a **Unit Card**, **Mission Card**, or Special Ability contradicts the Core Rules, the card or ability takes precedence.

2.7 ABILITY TYPES



Every Special Ability falls into one of three categories. Understanding the difference is essential, as it determines when the ability can be used, whether it requires a conscious decision, and what happens if both players want to act at the same time. Part 10 covers these in full detail; what follows is a working summary.

2.7.1 Active Abilities



Active Abilities are deliberate choices, a stim injection, a mode switch, a called shot. They require the Unit to be **Activated**, and must be triggered immediately before declaring an action or immediately after one fully resolves. A player cannot interrupt an action mid-flow to use one.

A Unit in Reserves cannot use Active Abilities unless the ability explicitly states otherwise. Each named **Active Ability** may be used only once per Round by a specific Unit, unless it has the REPEATABLE keyword. Effects granted by Active Abilities expire at the End of the Current Round unless otherwise stated.

2.7.2 Passive Abilities



Passive Abilities are always active. They represent innate traits, permanent equipment, or biological adaptations that require no de activate; they simply function as long as the Unit is on the batt

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Like Active Abilities, Passive Abilities are inactive while the Unit is in Reserves, unless otherwise stated.

2.7.3 Reaction Abilities

Reaction Abilities are the battlefield's reflexes. They fire in response to a specific trigger, such as an incoming attack, an Enemy Charge, or a model being Destroyed, and allow a player to act outside the normal activation sequence. The catch is timing: a Reaction must be declared at the **exact moment** its trigger occurs. If the moment passes, the opportunity is gone.

Each player may resolve only **one Reaction per Activation**.

Each named **Reaction Ability** may be used only **once per Round** by a specific Unit. This limit applies across the entire Round (all Phases and all Activations). A single Unit cannot use the same-named Reaction more than once per Round, even on different triggers.

Different Units may each use the same named Reaction once per Round.

If both players want to react to the same trigger, the Active Player resolves their **Reaction** first.

Like Active and Passive Abilities, Reaction Abilities cannot be used while the Unit is in Reserves unless stated otherwise.

EXAMPLE: If a Zealot Unit is attacked. It may use *Zealous Round* OR *Ground Armour*, not both in the same Enemy Activation.

If a Marine Unit is attacked, and it uses *Infantry Armor* for its Armour Roll, the Medic Unit behind will not be able to use its *Life Support* in the same Enemy Activation.